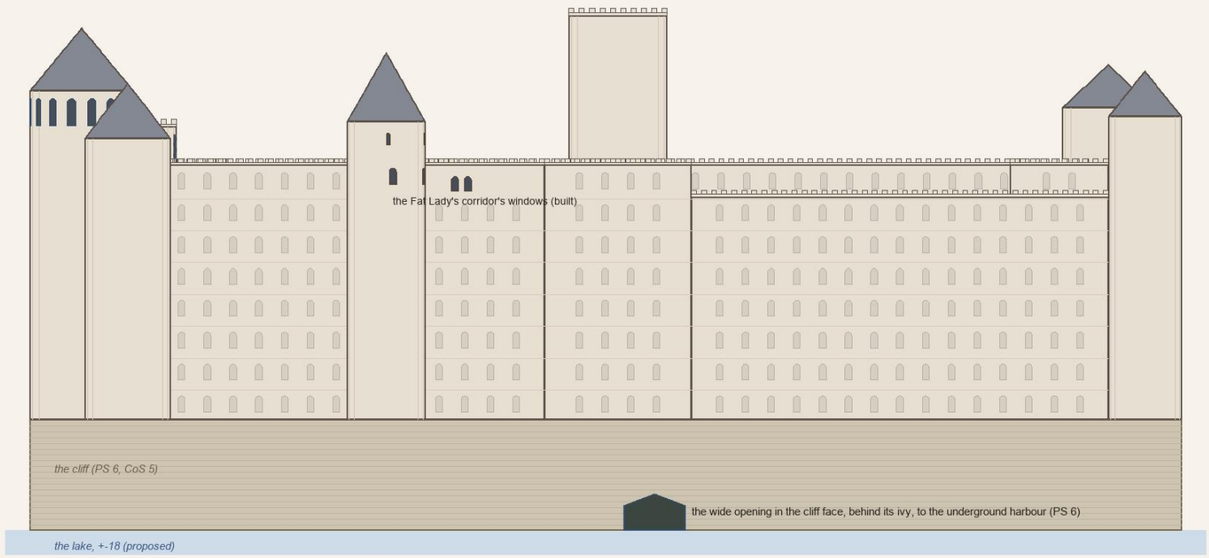
Question 6: where the castle began

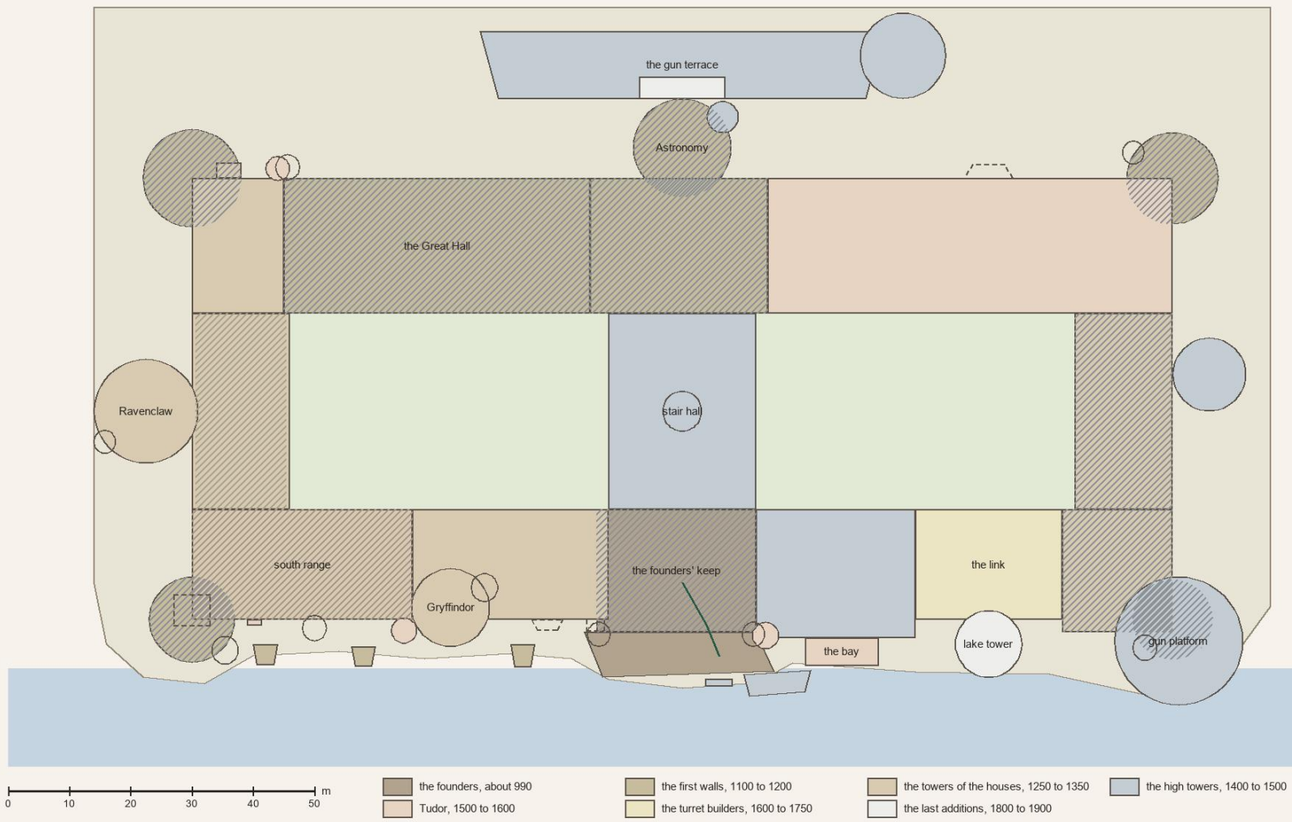
The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 6, after Question 5 (Godric's answer of 10.23 pm and his note of 10.28 pm). Every face drawn from one set of pieces placed in plan, age by age (the history, revised from the precedents). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

Canon, checked at the gate: Hogwarts "was founded over a thousand years ago", its four founders "built this castle together, far from prying Muggle eyes" (CoS 9); the harbour under the cliff behind its ivy (PS 6). Everything else is ours.

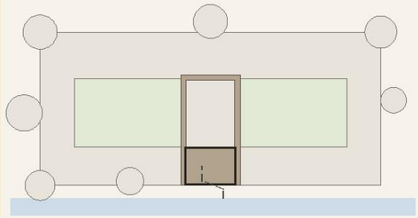
Now: the south face as it stands in the model (Question 5's "now"), 1:1000



Under 6.1: what each age built, ground floor, 1:1000. Raised in a later age: hatched in that age's colour; corbelled out: dashed. The rock's outline is proposed.



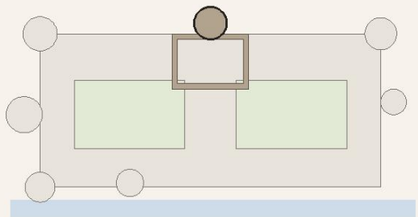
6.1 The founders' keep on the cliff, over the hidden harbour



A refuge reached from the lake by a passage in the rock, far from Muggle eyes (CoS 9): the boats' way in (PS 6) is the founders' own. Their walled ward became the stair hall's well.

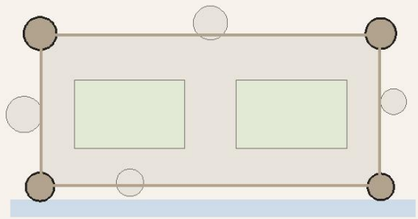
recommended

6.2 A gate keep at the front, grown into the Astronomy Tower



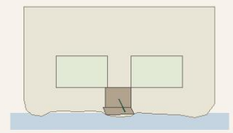
The highest tower is the oldest; the castle grew south to the cliff. The lake front is then all later work, and the harbour a later cut.

6.3 Four towers, one for each founder, joined by walls

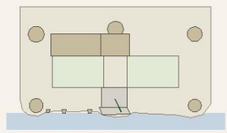


A square castle from the first day, the houses' towers the founders'. But two houses live below ground, and a square start reads as built at once.

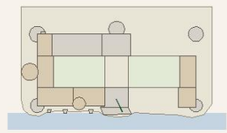
The growth, age by age (what stood before each age in grey)



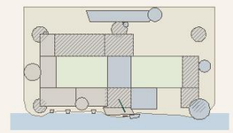
the founders, about 990



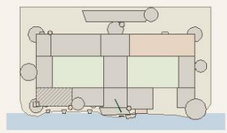
the first walls, 1100 to 1200



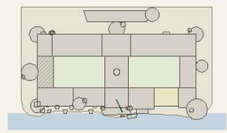
the towers of the houses, 1250 to 1350



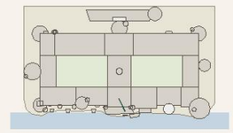
the high towers, 1400 to 1500



Tudor, 1500 to 1600



the turret builders, 1600 to 1750

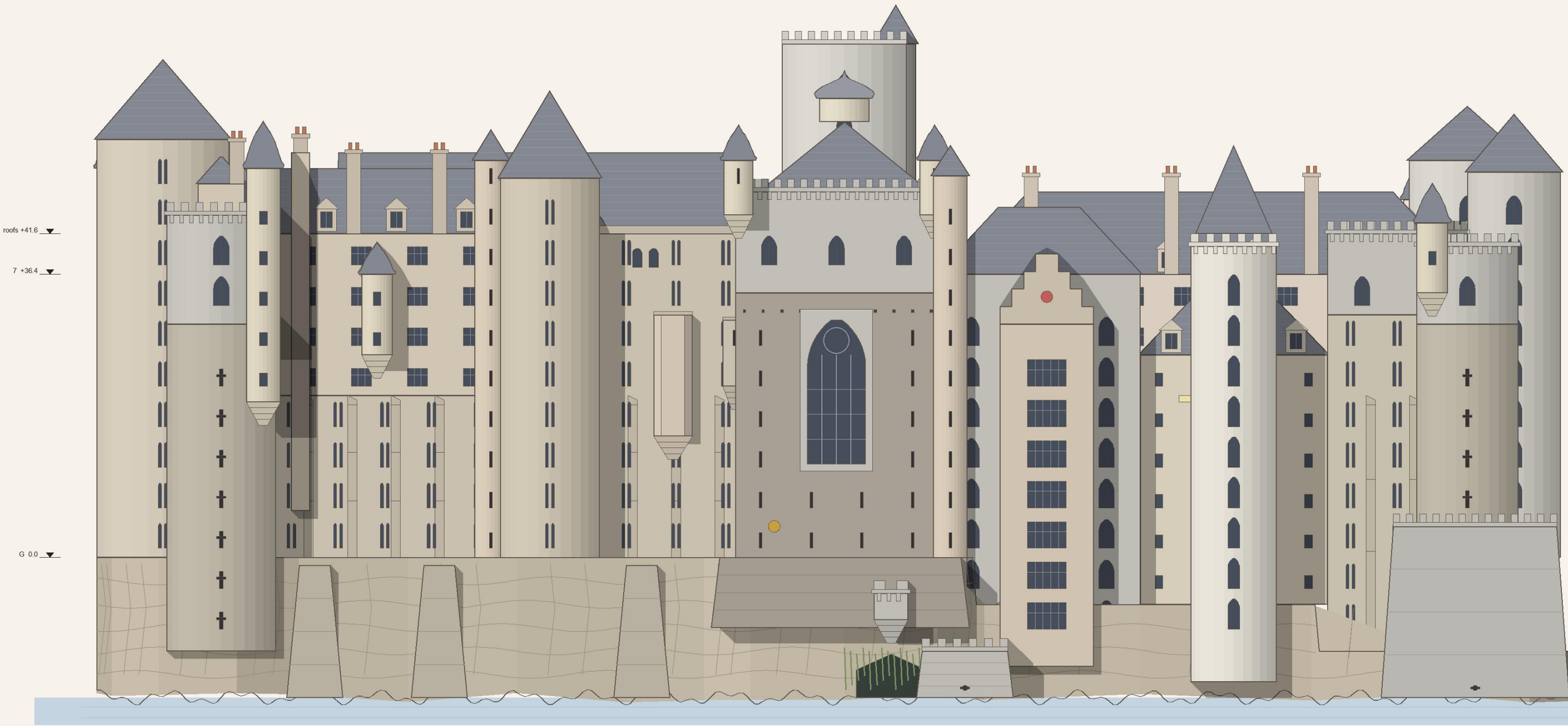


the last additions, 1800 to 1900

Under 6.1: the south face from the boats, in weathered stone

The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 6, after Question 5 (Godric's answer of 10.23 pm and his note of 10.28 pm). Every face drawn from one set of pieces placed in plan, age by age (the history, revised from the precedents). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

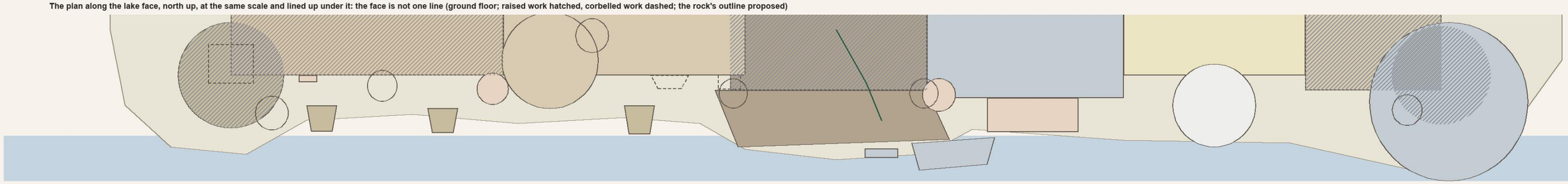
Drawn far to near from the pieces in plan, so towers stand in front of ranges, roofs show behind roofs and every piece casts its shadow on what stands behind it. The face is no longer one line: the keep stands out on its prow over the harbour, the hall range and its crow-stepped bay step down the ledges on vaults, the lake tower stands in front of the lower link, turrets cling where floor ran out, and the old battlements still show inside every raised wall. Held: Gryffindor Tower and its built windows, the corridor's windows on 7, the lead flat east of the tower at +41.6 (req 198), the Astronomy Tower the highest (HBP 27), nothing new above Gryffindor's cone at +60 but the stair hall's lantern (+62, behind).



0 10 20 30 40 50 m 1:500 printed at A3

Three marks to find from the boats: the lion on the keep (the oldest), the Tudor rose in the bay's gable, the date stone 1647 on the link.

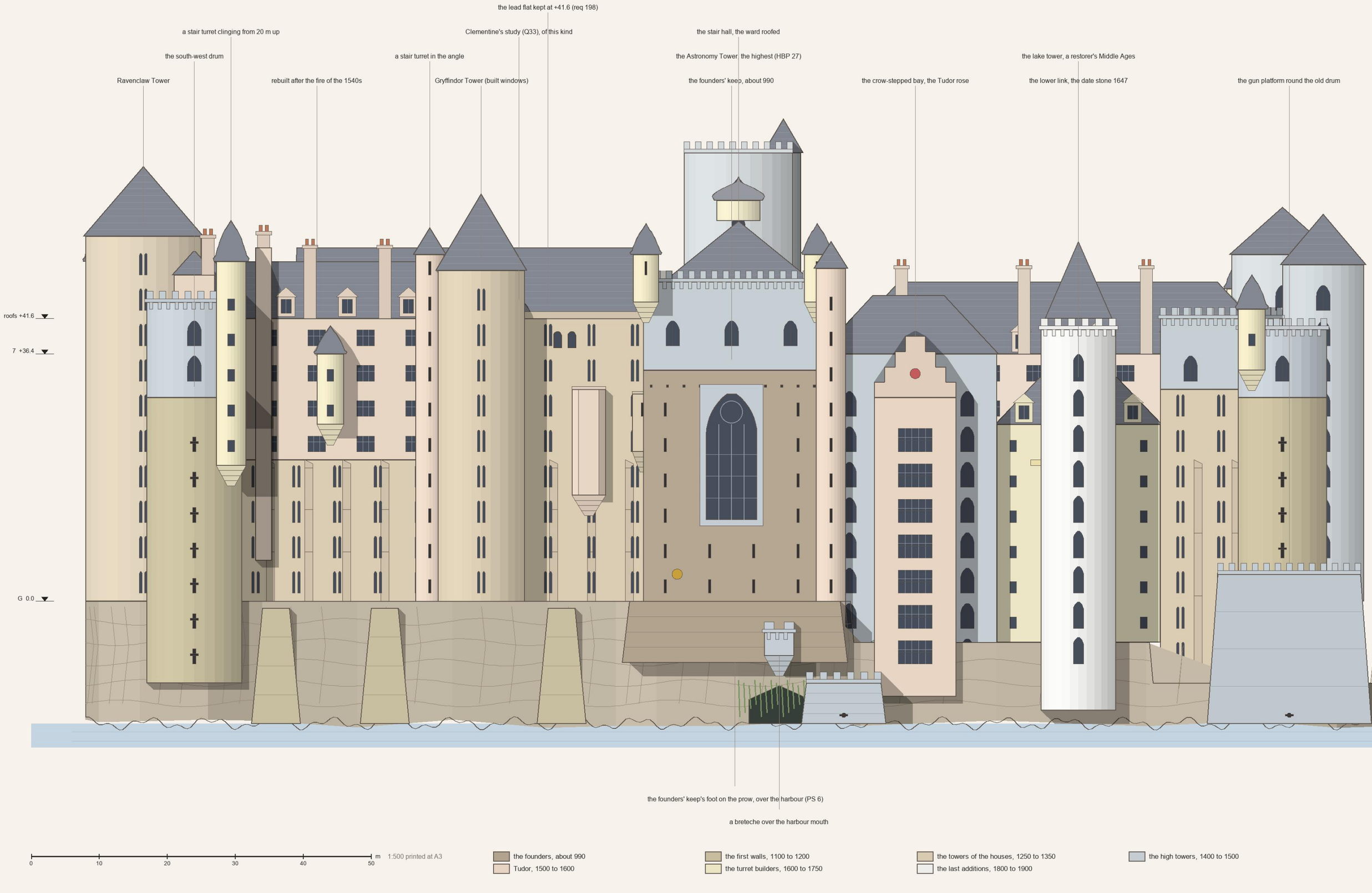
The plan along the lake face, north up, at the same scale and lined up under it: the face is not one line (ground floor; raised work hatched, corbelled work dashed; the rock's outline proposed)



Under 6.1: the south face by age, each age in its colour

The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 6, after Question 5 (Godric's answer of 10.23 pm and his note of 10.28 pm). Every face drawn from one set of pieces placed in plan, age by age (the history, revised from the precedents). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

Each colour is an age (the key below), each label a piece of the history. Read it as a builder would: the founders' keep the darkest and most solid, its slits and the holes of its first timber hoardings; each later age raised a wall over its old battlements (they show as a line of blocked gaps), cut bigger windows into old work, hung turrets and oriels out on corbels where floor ran out, and capped its towers its own way: battlements, machicolations, cones, bell caps, an ogee lantern.



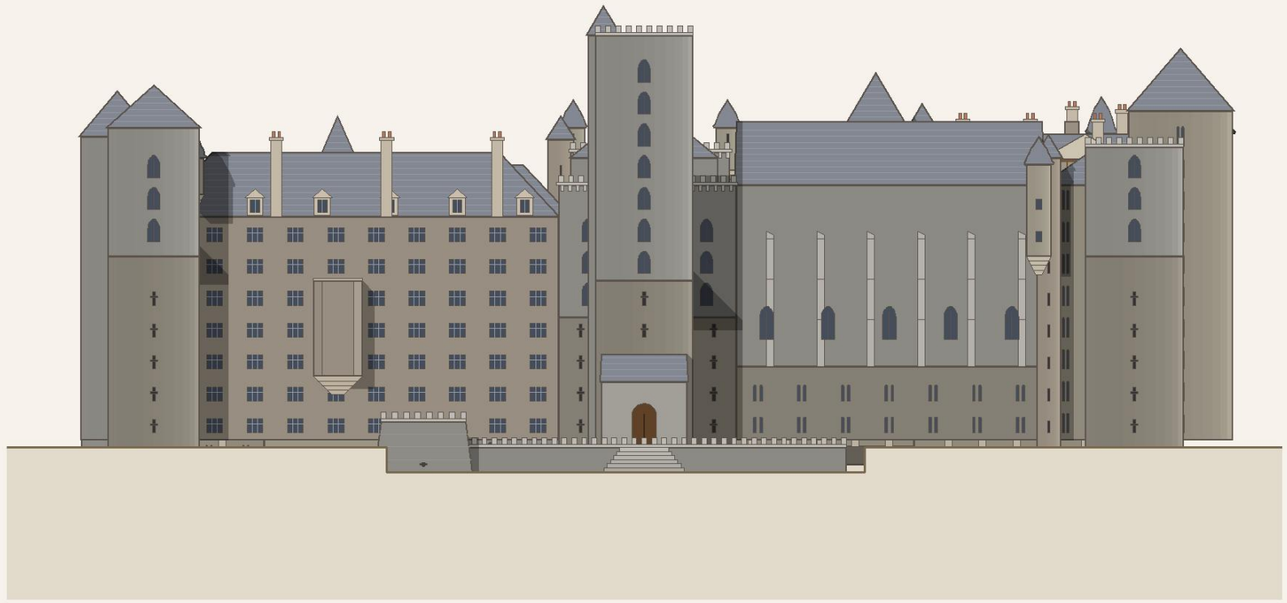
0 10 20 30 40 50 m — 1:500 printed at A3

- the founders, about 990
- Tudor, 1500 to 1600
- the first walls, 1100 to 1200
- the turret builders, 1600 to 1750
- the towers of the houses, 1250 to 1350
- the last additions, 1800 to 1900
- the high towers, 1400 to 1500

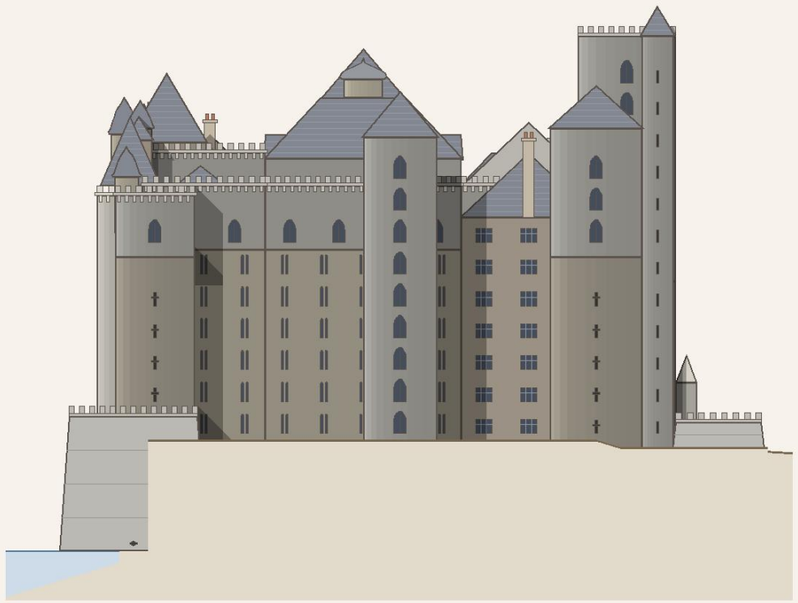
Under 6.1: the other three faces, from the same pieces, 1:1000

The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 6, after Question 5 (Godric's answer of 10.23 pm and his note of 10.28 pm). Every face drawn from one set of pieces placed in plan, age by age (the history, revised from the precedents). Model version 5; ours unless a book line is named.

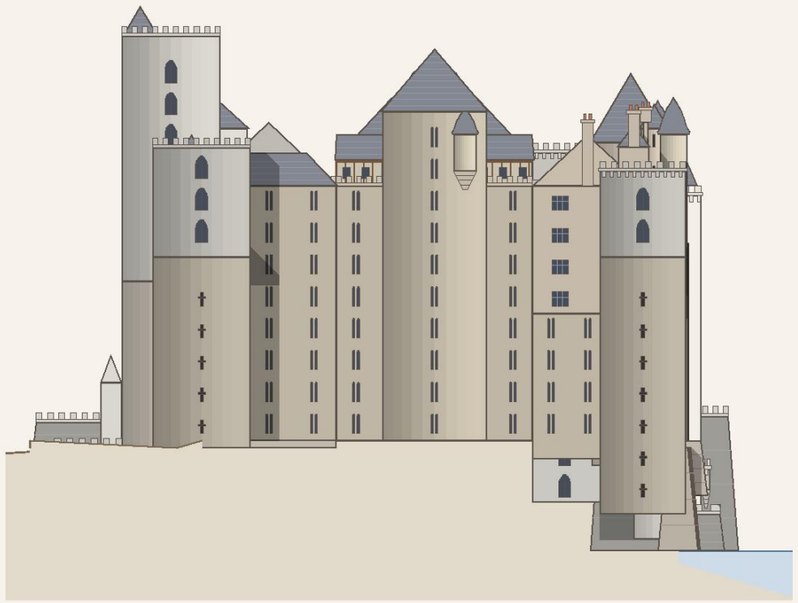
The north face, the entrance front: the gun terrace and the stone steps (PS 6, GoF 12) up to the oak doors under the Astronomy Tower (OotP 31)



The east face (seen from the east)



The west face (seen from the west)



0 10 20 30 40 50 m 1:1000 printed at A3